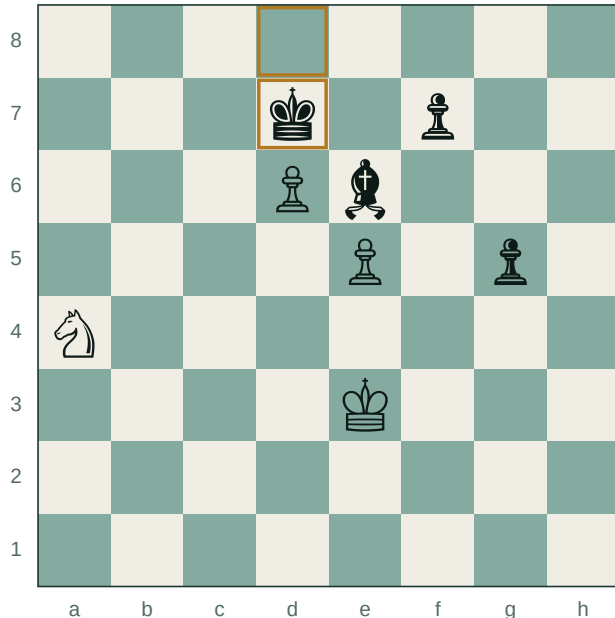


Deflection tactics: White, move 55

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 54...Kd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

55. Nc5+ Kc6 56. Nxe6

55.Nc5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From c5 it attacks king on d7 and bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **55...Kc6**.

56.Nxe6 The knight captures the bishop on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on d7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.